

Going beyond the old 'Kitna deti hai?'

India's roads **go the distance** - 6.6 mn km to be **precise**, second only to the US. But **scale** has **come at a cost**. Poor design, **crumbling** surfaces and **erratic signages** have turned **stretches** into death traps. And while **infrastructure** plays a role, 'the biggest **cause** of road accidents', as Nitin Gadkari said in 2023, '**is** human behaviour'. Every year, 1,78,000 lives are lost in road crashes, with 80% of **fatalities** linked to speeding or unsafe vehicles. But, out of this **grim** record, a welcome shift is taking shape. In a market long ruled by **affordability**, safety is emerging as a **key**, well, **driver**. **5-star Bharat NCAP** (New Car Assessment Programme)-rated vehicles **made up** 15% of all passenger vehicle sales in Q1 2025 - up from 10% a year earlier. Sales of top-rated models rose 12% in 2024, even as overall car sales grew 4.3%.

Features once seen as luxuries - 6 airbags, electronic stability control (ESC), anti-lock braking system (ABS), electronic brakeforce distribution (EBD), Isofix mounts (for child safety), etc - **are** fast becoming standard. With Global NCAP and Bharat NCAP crash-testing Indian cars, buyers now have clearer **insight** into structural safety. Poor safety ratings have also pushed manufacturers to use high-tensile steel more widely and offer extras like 360° **pivot** cameras, remote **surveillance** and driving alerts.



This **expanding** view of safety is **reshaping** India's \$137 bn auto industry, set to grow to \$203 bn by 2030. Carmakers are **doubling down on** R&D, especially around crash protection and vehicle **integrity**. The **goal** to **halve** road fatalities by 2030 **is ambitious**, but achievable. Tech and regulation can take us far. But the final stretch depends on us. Because **half the battle** is engineering. The other half is **in the driver's seat**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Signages** (noun) – signs collectively, especially commercial or public display signs.

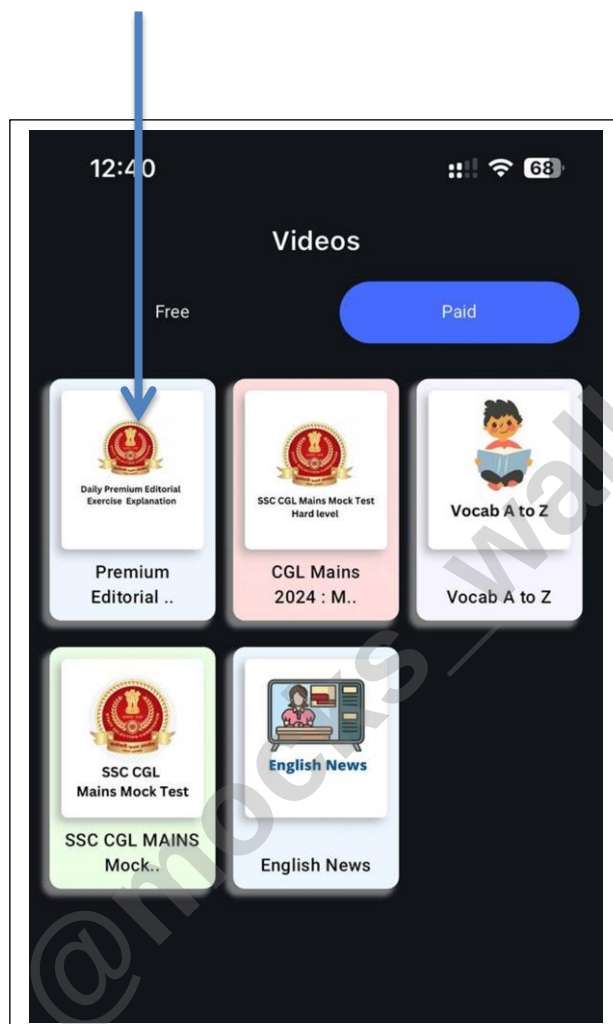
Vocabulary

1. **Go the distance** (phrase) – endure, last, persevere, stay the course, sustain दृढ़ता से पूरा करना
2. **Precise** (adjective) – exact, accurate, specific, clear, unambiguous सटीक
3. **Scale** (noun) – size, extent, magnitude, level, scope पैमाना / स्तर
4. **Come at a cost** (phrase) – involve sacrifice, incur loss, lead to consequences, bring harm, have downside कीमत चुकाकर मिलना
5. **Crumbling** (adjective) – deteriorating, collapsing, falling apart, weakening, decaying टूटता हुआ
6. **Erratic** (adjective) – unpredictable, inconsistent, irregular, unstable, fluctuating अस्थिर / अनियमित
7. **Stretch** (noun) – section, span, segment, portion, part हिस्सा / खंड
8. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, foundation, facilities, systems, base आधारभूत संरचना
9. **Fatality** (noun) – death, casualty, demise, loss of life, mortality मृत्यु
10. **Grim** (adjective) – bleak, harsh, depressing, gloomy, dreadful भयावह
11. **Affordability** (noun) – cost-effectiveness, reasonableness, economic feasibility, cheapness वहनशीलता
12. **Key** (adjective) – crucial, important, vital, essential, significant महत्वपूर्ण
13. **Driver** (noun) – motivator, catalyst, cause, force, influencer प्रेरक शक्ति
14. **Insight** (noun) – understanding, perception, awareness, observation, comprehension अंतर्दृष्टि
15. **Pivot** (noun) – the rotational point around which a camera moves.
16. **Surveillance** (noun) – monitoring, observation, scrutiny, watch, supervision निगरानी
17. **Expanding** (adjective) – growing, increasing, enlarging, extending, developing फैलता हुआ
18. **Reshape** (verb) – transform, modify, reform, revamp, reconfigure फिर से आकार देना
19. **Double down on** (phrase) – reinforce effort, intensify focus, commit strongly, emphasize, push harder दोगुना प्रयास करना

20. **Integrity** (noun) – strength, soundness, durability, cohesion, unity अखंडता / मजबूती
21. **Halve** (verb) – reduce by 50%, cut down, lessen, diminish, divide in two आधा करना
22. **Ambitious** (adjective) – aspirational, determined, bold, goal-oriented, high-reaching महत्वाकांक्षी
23. **Half the battle** (phrase) – partial success, initial challenge, beginning step, only part of the task आधी चुनौती
24. **In the driver's seat** (phrase) – in control, in charge, leading, managing, having authority नियंत्रण में होना

@mocks_wallah

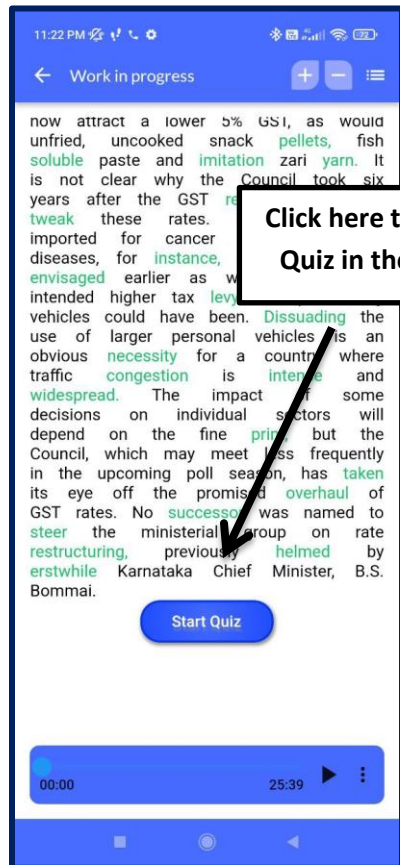
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



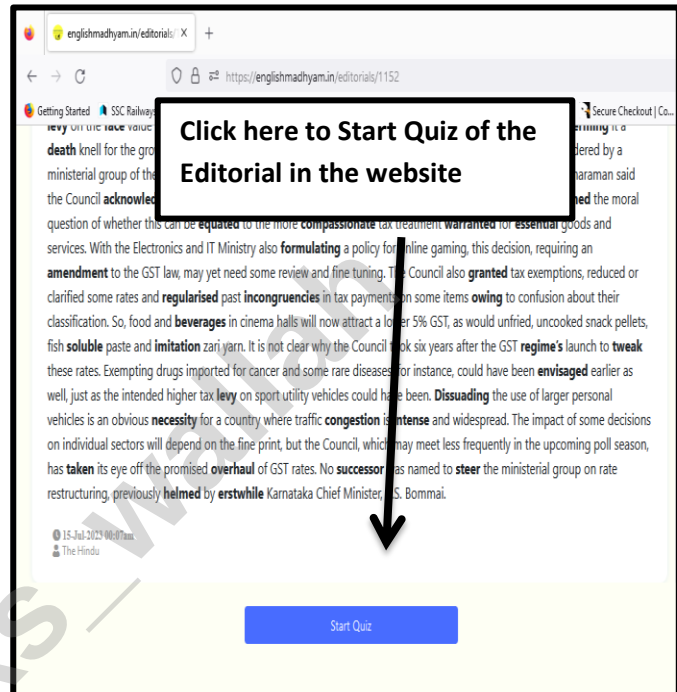
Summary of the Editorial

1. **India's Expansive Road Network** – India now has 6.6 million km of roads, making it the second largest network globally, behind the U.S.
2. **Quality Lags Behind Quantity** – Despite the scale, many roads are plagued by poor design, damaged surfaces, and inadequate signages, increasing accident risks.
3. **Human Error Dominates Accidents** – As per Nitin Gadkari (2023), human behaviour is the leading cause of road accidents, not just infrastructure flaws.
4. **Disturbing Fatality Rate** – Annually, 1.78 lakh people die in road crashes, with 80% of fatalities linked to speeding and unsafe vehicles.
5. **Shift Toward Safety Awareness** – The Indian auto market is seeing a growing emphasis on safety over just fuel efficiency and affordability.
6. **Rising Sales of Safer Cars** – In Q1 2025, cars rated 5-star by Bharat NCAP made up 15% of all passenger vehicle sales, up from 10% the previous year.
7. **Strong Growth in Top-rated Models** – Sales of 5-star safety-rated models rose by 12% in 2024, outpacing overall car sales growth of 4.3%.
8. **Safety Features Becoming Standard** – Features like 6 airbags, ABS, ESC, EBD, and Isofix mounts are increasingly offered as standard, not luxury add-ons.
9. **Better Consumer Awareness** – Crash testing by Global NCAP and Bharat NCAP has given buyers clear insights into vehicle safety and build quality.
10. **Manufacturers Respond to Ratings** – Poor safety scores have compelled automakers to use high-tensile steel and integrate advanced driver assistance systems.
11. **High-Tech Additions Rise** – 360° cameras, remote vehicle surveillance, and real-time driver alerts are being included to boost driver confidence and safety.
12. **Auto Industry Transformation** – India's \$137 billion auto sector is undergoing a safety-driven transformation and is projected to reach \$203 billion by 2030.
13. **Increased R&D Investment** – Carmakers are prioritizing research into crash protection, vehicle integrity, and advanced safety technologies.
14. **Vision 2030: Halve Road Deaths** – The national goal to reduce road fatalities by 50% by 2030 is ambitious but within reach with combined tech and behavioural change.
15. **Responsibility Lies with Drivers Too** – While engineering and regulation are key, driver awareness and responsible behaviour remain crucial to road safety.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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